

# About the Innovate Africa Challenge

# Thematic Areas

While all solutions that leverage AI to solve climate change-related challenges are encouraged to apply, some of the thematic areas that can be considered include, but are not limited to:

| Thematic Area                        | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Examples                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Climate Smart Agriculture            | CSA is a set of agricultural practices and technologies which simultaneously boost productivity, enhance resilience to climate change and reduce and/ or remove GHG emissions.                                                                                                                                       | Precision farming, Smart irrigation, Geonomics Analysis, Yield Prediction, Farm Management Softwares, Crop Monitoring and Management                                                                         |
| Efficient Transport Systems          | Using data on traffic patterns, passenger demand and weather conditions, AI algorithms can identify opportunities to curtail emissions and augment efficiency in transport systems. This can result in substantial cost savings, as well as a decline in GHG emissions and a more sustainable transportation sector. | AI-Managed Charging Infrastructure, demand-responsive transit, AI-based navigation apps                                                                                                                      |
| Waste Management                     | Use of AI can allow for identifying and sorting waste with higher accuracy. Artificial intelligence combined with chemical analysis can improve waste pyrolysis, carbon emission estimation, and energy conversion                                                                                                   | Smart waste bins, robotic recycling, landfill monitoring etc.                                                                                                                                                |
| Disaster preparedness and management | AI-driven technologies offer improved modelling and predicting climate change patterns can help communities and authorities to draft effective adaptation and mitigation strategies.                                                                                                                                 | Weather and meteorological event prediction models, AI for disaster response and recovery, use of space technology in weather prediction etc.                                                                |
| Natural Resource Management          | AI in natural resource management can enhance monitoring and conservation efforts. Machine learning algorithms can analyze satellite imagery to track deforestation, assess biodiversity, and monitor land use changes with greater efficiency.                                                                      | Predictive modeling for sustainable fisheries management, precision agriculture for optimized resource use, automated monitoring of illegal logging activities using satellite imagery and machine learning. |
| Energy Efficiency                    | AI plays a crucial role in optimizing energy consumption and improving efficiency across various sectors. Smart grids, predictive maintenance, and energy demand forecasting are some applications that contribute to sustainable energy management.                                                                 | Smart grid technology using AI for real-time energy distribution, predictive maintenance of energy infrastructure, AI-driven energy consumption analytics for businesses and households etc.                 |

# Value Proposition for Successful Applicants

| Category              | Value Proposition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Top 16 Participants   | <p>Below are the benefits for top 16 participants:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Participation in a virtual 2-week onboarding bootcamp (comprising a series of cohort based as well as one-on-one training sessions) that will enable the participants to refine their solutions</li><li>• Support in fine-tuning their proposals in preparation for the virtual pitch</li><li>• Opportunity to engage with other participants to potentially establish partnerships for building/ refining solutions together</li><li>• Opportunity to participate in a virtual pitch and showcase their solutions to a jury of experts</li><li>• Coverage on social media platforms of challenge organizers and key partners as top 16 participants of the Innovate Africa Challenge</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Top 8 Participants    | <p>The top 8 participants identified post virtual pitches will be incorporated into a 3- month incubation program and have access to the following benefits:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Coverage on social media platforms of challenge organizers and key partners as top 8 teams undergoing incubation in the Innovate Africa Challenge</li><li>• A pool of AI &amp; Climate experts will provide business support services and technical expertise, and work with the top 8 teams to fine-tune their solutions. This support will be provided in the form of cohort-based as well as one-on-one training sessions</li><li>• Towards the end of incubation period, five out of the top eight participants will receive support in developing proposals to be presented to a grand jury of experts</li><li>• The top 5 will have an opportunity to attend an in-person pitch event to showcase the AI for Climate Action solution to be implemented in one of the target countries (Rwanda, Ghana or Kenya) before a jury</li><li>• The event will also enable networking opportunities for the participating teams with other relevant ecosystem stakeholders</li></ul> |
| Winner of the program | <p>In addition to the above, benefits for the winner of the program will include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Coverage on social media platforms of the challenge organizers and key partners as the winner of the Innovate Africa Challenge</li><li>• A service contract, valued at \$50,000, for the implementation of the solution. The contract will include clear deliverables based on a revised proposal (pending adjustments to be agreed upon by both parties)</li><li>• Support in curating a road map for implementation of the solution</li><li>• An in-person visit to the location where the solution will be implemented, to enable preparatory work in line with agreed upon roadmap activities</li><li>• Access to a pool of relevant experts who will aid implementation of the solution</li><li>• Connections with relevant implementation partners for the solution provider</li><li>• M&amp;E support for the ongoing implementation of the solution</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## Evaluation criteria

Below criteria will be used to shortlist and identify the top 16 participants for the challenge.

- 1. Sustainability:** Solution provider should be able to showcase sustainability of the solution as well as its business model over a period of time, in terms of the value proposition to an identified customer base, sustainable revenue and cost model, competitiveness and innovativeness of the solution etc.
- 2. Impact:** Solution provider should be able to showcase the economic, social and environmental impact of the solution
- 3. Team:** Solution provider should have a dedicated team with complementary skillsets in terms of both business and relevant technical expertise (i.e. proficiency in AI and climate related solution development). The team should be diverse in terms of gender, age, nationality etc.
- 4. Compliance:** Solution should be compliant with all relevant regulations within their country of registration or operation. Solution provider should have requisite licenses from authorized institutions or have detailed processes in place to ensure compliance with the same
- 5. Technical Feasibility:** It should be feasible to build the solution using existing tools and resources
- 6. Usability:** Solution should be aligned to needs of target audience and have a user-friendly interface
- 7. Robustness and Adaptability:** Solution provider should showcase the different scenarios that the solution can handle and its ability to adjust to new data or emerging trends (in line with evolving climate change related challenges)
- 8. Accessibility and Inclusivity:** Solution should be accessible to diverse communities and demographics, including marginalized or vulnerable populations disproportionately affected by climate change

## 39 Eligible countries

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Algeria</li><li>• Angola</li><li>• Benin</li><li>• Burundi</li><li>• Burkina Faso</li><li>• Cape Verde</li><li>• Cameroon</li><li>• Chad</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Congo – Brazaville</li><li>• Comoros</li><li>• Ivory Coast</li><li>• Djibouti</li><li>• Egypt</li><li>• Gabon</li><li>• Ghana</li><li>• Guinea( Conakry)</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Kingdom Of Eswatini</li><li>• Kenya</li><li>• Mali</li><li>• Malawi</li><li>• Niger</li><li>• Nigeria</li><li>• Mauritania</li><li>• Madagascar</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Drc</li><li>• Rwanda</li><li>• Kingdom Of Morocco</li><li>• Sao Tome And Principe</li><li>• Senegal</li><li>• Sierra Leone</li><li>• South Africa</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Sudan</li><li>• South Sudan</li><li>• Togo</li><li>• Gambia</li><li>• Tunisia</li><li>• Uganda</li><li>• Zambia</li><li>• Zimbabwe</li></ul> |
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